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The cultural landscape and maritime identity of Szczecin: The past and present of a port city

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Abstract

This article analyses the maritime cultural landscape of Szczecin, a port city connected by a river and a lagoon to the Baltic Sea, although at a considerable distance from the coast. The natural landscape does not have elements that are typically associated with the sea, but the local cultural landscape consists of many objects with maritime motifs and symbols (in particular monuments and other material elements). The study shows that the maritime cultural landscape of Szczecin can be divided into several categories: the cultural heritage connected with the German past, the communist period and present day. In each of these periods, the emphasis was placed on other functions of the cultural elements of the maritime landscape while maintaining its maritime identity. The authors used a variety of methods and research tools. This study was based on analysis of found documents. Visual data analysis was also used.

Keywords

maritime cultural landscape, maritime identity, maritime monuments, harbour landscape, space recycling

The aim of this article is to analyse how elements of an urban landscape, especially a maritime cultural landscape, create the maritime identity of a city. We present the maritime cultural landscape of the port city of Szczecin, concentrating on those elements that are a significant part of the city's social memory, that emphasize its maritime identity and

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can be considered a material symbol – a way of commemorating the past,[1] i.e. important events, people and places. These elements are important for the micro-community; they have both symbolic and educational functions, playing a substantial role in the identity of the city and its maritime character, and also influence urban policy. What unites them is their uniqueness and strong connection with the city and its history; if they were moved out of the city, they would lose their original meaning. Since any space will store the various meanings that overlap with time, these elements can constitute layers of the urban palimpsest.

In analysing Szczecin's maritime landscape, we used a variety of research methods and tools. Their complementary nature allows for a richer and more in-depth analysis of the collected research material. According to *The SAGE Handbook of Qualitative Research*, 'qualitative research is inherently multi-method in focus. However, the use of multiple methods, or triangulation, reflects an attempt to secure an in-depth understanding of the phenomenon in question'.[2] With regard to the archival documents and historical sources used in this paper, we applied critical analysis to confirm their authenticity and reliability and to facilitate reconstruction of the research problem within the established chronological framework. We also used visual data analysis, which includes all objects, places, events and situations that are subject to observation.[3] In this research, we took into account the sets of man-made material forms constituting cultural records arranged in time and space like a palimpsest, which can be studied as symbolically significant artefacts.[4]

Visual research does not imply a focus solely on visuals with no regard for other research methods. In fact, images are embedded in a social context with its interrelations of visuality, culture and history. Visual history, one example of multidisciplinary research dealing with (audio)visual representations in a historical context, encompasses all areas at the intersection of history and historiography, photography, film, visual arts, new media and all visualizations of the past and historical knowledge.[5]

Assuming that analysis of visual data includes visual representations of history, we look at our pictorial data as a whole, and the meaning of details is decoded only in the final stage of research, while reviewing the complete research material.[6] This means

1. Barbara Szacka, 'Pamięć społeczna', in *Encyklopedia Socjologii*, vol. III (Warsaw, 2000), 52.
2. Norman K. Denzin and Yvonna S. Lincoln, 'Introduction: The Discipline and Practice of Qualitative Research', in idem (eds), *The SAGE Handbook of Qualitative Research* (Thousand Oaks, 2011), 26.
3. Michael Emmision and Philip Smith, *Researching the Visual* (London, 2000), 4; Piotr Sztompka, *Socjologia wizualna. Fotografia jako metoda badawcza* (Warsaw, 2005), 35.
4. Brian Stuart Osborne, 'Landscapes, Memory, Monuments, and Commemoration: Putting Identity in its Place', in *Commissioned by the Department of Canadian Heritage for the Ethnocultural, Racial, Religious, and Linguistic Diversity and Identity Seminar* (Halifax, 2001). Available at: https://epe.lac-bac.gc.ca/100/200/300/citizenship_and_immigration_canada_metropolis/landscapes_memory-e/putinden.pdf (accessed 5 July 2020).
5. Dorota Skotarczak, *Historia wizualna* (Poznań, 2012).
6. Piotr Witek, 'Metodologiczne problemy historii wizualnej', *Res Historica*, 37 (2014), 159–76.

that we can determine the meaning of patterns by locating visual data elements in a complete context – in our case, the maritime cultural landscape.

In our analysis of selected maritime objects at an iconological level,[7] we decided that objects – monuments and other maritime elements – acquire important symbolic values and carry certain social meanings typical of their historical periods (German past, communist post-war period, present day). Consideration of the background that determines the symbolic value of objects allows us to relate them to a broader social, cultural and historical context – in this sense, a work of art becomes a testimony of its time. We selected only those objects that included maritime accents and symbolism, which were then analysed in the context of the maritime cultural landscape as well as the social and historical contexts of the city.

Finally, we assumed that the value and meaning of a visual object change as it moves through time and space. According to Arjun Appadurai,[8] although in theory any meaning can be given to any object, in practice, the functioning of meanings is limited by the cultural context in which the object came into existence. This entails the recontextualization of objects[9] – i.e. where cultural contexts can modify the meanings of objects or even transform them completely. In this way, objects have not just a social life but also their own specific biography.

Identity of place, heritage and maritime cultural landscape

A key issue related to the description of public spaces and cultural landscapes is the identity of the place – its distinctiveness, uniqueness and main characteristic features – related to the 'embedding' of urban structures in local conditions and contexts. An important component of this collective identity is the social memory of its past, diverse in its manifestations and contents, on a local scale (the former role of a city or region in the national settlement network), as well as national and universal scale. This social nature of memory has been increasingly a focus of interest in Humanities and Social Sciences since the 1980s.[10] According to Paul Connerton, societies remember in three different ways:

7. Erwin Panofsky, 'Ikonografia i ikonologia', in idem, *Studia z historii sztuki* (Warsaw, 1971), 20–36.
8. Arjun Appadurai, 'Introduction: Commodities and the Politics of Value', in idem (ed.), *The Social Life of Things: Commodities in Cultural Perspective* (Cambridge, 1986), 3–63.
9. Nicholas Thomas, *Entangled Objects: Exchange, Material Culture and Colonialism in the Pacific* (London, 1991).
10. David W. Blight, 'The Memory Boom: Why and Why Now?', in Pascal Boyer and James Wertsch (eds), *Memory in Mind and Culture* (Cambridge, 2009), 238–51; Andreas Huyssen, *Twilight Memories. Making Time in a Culture of Amnesia* (New York, 1995); Barbara A. Misztal, *Theories of Social Remembering* (Philadelphia, 2003); Pierre Nora, *Realms of Memory* (3 vols, New York, 1996); John Nerone, 'Professional History and Social Memory', *Communication*, 11 (1989), 89–104; Jeffrey K. Olick and Joyce Robbins, 'Social Memory Studies: From "Collective Memory" to the Historical Sociology of Mnemonic Practices', *Annual Review of Sociology*, 24 (1998), 105–40; Tuula Sakaranaho, 'Religion and the Study of Social Memory', *The Finnish Society for the Study of Religion*, 47, No. 2 (2011), 135–58; Geoff A. Wilson, 'Community Resilience and Social Memory', *Environmental Values*, 24, No. 2 (2015), 227–57.

through inscriptions on cultural texts, such as monuments; through remembrance rituals that engage people; and by incorporating social memory into the human body. Thus, social memory refers to the dynamic interaction between history, culture and cognition.[11]

Doreen Massey proposes a broad approach to the concept of 'identity of place'.[12] First of all, everything that is specific to a place and its identity is always created by the juxtaposition of a particular set of social connections and the effects they produce. Moreover, the identity of a place is the result not only of an internalized history, but also of the specificity of its interaction with the external environment. In addition to the local history and tradition, the attributes of identity include characteristic (unusual) forms present in a place, features of the natural environment and the perceived 'magical' aspect of the site.[13] Features of the cultural environment and history are reflected in the consciousness of those city dwellers – history experienced directly and history passed down through generations. Identity is thus created in a specific culture, time and territory; the destruction of historical spaces may result in a loss of cultural identity.

Identity is associated with the construction of meaningful places which include landscapes, monuments and places where commemoration is carried out, collective memory is strengthened and national identity is built in both formal and informal ways.[14] Monuments, streets, districts, buildings, churches and parks are material things, yet they also evoke specific meanings and serve as spatial coordinates of identity.[15] The concept of the identity of a place can be considered in the context of collective identity, namely territorial (local) identity and its urban-architectural dimension. Local identity is a specific type of social and cultural identity based on local traditions, related to a clearly defined territory (place) and its distinct cultural, economic or topographical features.[16] For example, in the architectural perspective, regional identity is constituted by distinct architectural forms and urban planning dominating a given area.

The concept of cultural heritage refers to both tangible objects and intangible cultural practices. By constantly evolving as a result of changing ideologies, the analysis of cultural heritage requires an investigation of social, political and cultural contexts.[17] The creation of heritage is a process whose meaning is continually created, recreated and

11. Paul Connerton, *How Societies Remember* (Cambridge, 1989); Christopher J. Hewer and Ron Roberts, 'History, Culture and Cognition: Towards a Dynamic Model of Social Memory', *Culture & Psychology*, 18, No. 2 (2012), 167–83.
12. Doreen Massey, *Place, Space and Gender* (Minneapolis, 2001).
13. Piotr Lorens, 'Definiowanie współczesnej przestrzeni publicznej', in Piotr Lorens and Justyna Martyniuk-Pęczek (eds), *Problemy kształtowania przestrzeni publicznych* (Gdańsk, 2010), 6–20.
14. Osborne, 'Landscapes, Memory, Monuments'.
15. Kevin Lynch, *What Time is this Place* (Cambridge, 1972).
16. Marek Stanisław Szczepański, 'Społeczności lokalne i regionalne a ład kontynentalny i globalny', in Włodzimierz Wesołowski and Jan Włodarek (eds), *Kręgi integracji i rodzaje tożsamości. Polska, Europa, świat* (Warsaw, 2005), 121–40.
17. Brian Graham, 'Heritage as Knowledge: Capital or Culture?' *Urban Studies*, 39, Nos 5–6 (2002), 1003–17.

valorized, and also contested.[18] All heritage is someone else's heritage – a fact that may not necessarily be recognized by some groups.[19] The issues of ownership or interpretation may result in conflict. 'Contested heritage' refers to a condition in which a lack of congruence occurs over time or space between a community and its heritage.[20] Contested heritage includes cultural heritage (tangible and intangible) and natural heritage (national parks, urban waterfronts). In *A Systematic Review of Literature on Contested Heritage*,[21] Yang Liu, Karine Dupré and Xin Jan show how research on contested heritage invites deeper reflection on what heritage means and how it should be treated, as well as highlighting the contestation between continuity and change in heritage management.

Because heritage is used to 'construct, reconstruct and negotiate a range of identities and social and cultural values and meanings in the present',[22] the memory and meaning attached to heritage can change from generation to generation. Consequently, maintaining a balance between apparently controversial preservation of heritage and the inevitability of change within this dynamic process will always be a very complex and challenging task.[23] Exploring the relationship between heritage, memory and identity is possible through the study of cultural landscapes.[24] These landscapes are composed of layers resulting from the changing economic, political, cultural and demographic factors affecting a given society, and bear witness to different histories and geographies.[25]

Cultural landscapes are in constant flux – they consistently evolve and mutate. Landscape can thus be thought of as a pictorial way of representing, ordering or symbolizing the environment. Any analysis of a landscape should therefore focus on the visual images and symbols that have created it. As already mentioned, inherent in visual symbols is the context in which they are placed and the environment in which they are located and influenced, so each social group and individual is likely to shape reality differently, bending symbolism to their needs and values.[26] Landscapes are therefore open to interpretation as well as contestation. Visual features of cultural landscapes, such as

18. Yvonne Whelan, *Reinventing Modern Dublin* (Dublin, 2003); Sara McDowell, 'Heritage, Memory and Identity', in Brian Graham and Peter Howard (eds), *The Ashgate Research Companion to Heritage and Identity* (London, 2008), 37–53; Yang Liu, Karine Dupré and Xin Jin, 'A Systematic Review of Literature on Contested Heritage', *Current Issues in Tourism*, 24, No. 4 (2021), 442–65.
19. John E. Tunbridge and Gregory J. Ashworth, *Dissonant Heritage: The Management of the Past as a Resource in Conflict* (Chichester, NY, 1996), 21.
20. Gregory J. Ashworth, 'Holocaust Tourism: The Experience of Kraków-Kazimierz', *International Research in Geographical and Environmental Education*, 11, No. 4 (2002), 363–7.
21. Liu, Dupré and Jin, 'A Systematic Review'.
22. Laurajane Smith, *Uses of Heritage* (London, 2006), 3.
23. Liu, Dupré and Jin, 'A Systematic Review', 15.
24. McDowell, 'Heritage, Memory and Identity', 37–53.
25. Kay Anderson and Fay Gale, *Inventing Places: Studies in Cultural Geography* (Melbourne, 1992), 4.
26. Anthony D. Buckley, 'Introduction. Daring Us to Laugh: Creativity and Power in Northern Irish Symbols', in idem (ed.), *Symbols in Northern Ireland* (Belfast, 1998), 87–108.

monuments or other elements in the space of a maritime city that are tangible representations of the landscape map selective interpretations of the past and present in public places. As such, they articulate heritage and can be read as icons of identity and spatial signs of history. The cultural landscape is thus an essential resource for understanding the complex relationship between heritage, memory and identity.

Significantly, the term 'cultural landscape' has a plethora of connotations. The definition of 'landscape' can encompass humanistic geography, landscape studies, sociology, psychology, landscape architecture or literature and art. In this study, we follow the specific definition of a landscape as 'a collection of mixed elements of natural and man-made work – the effect of the activities of specific historical people, within a framework set by technology and social organization'.[27] A cultural landscape is generally understood as a landscape modified by humans.[28] 'The gradual disappearance of the traditional natural landscape as a result of human activity has, in a way, created room for the emergence of a cultural landscape. By transcending the purely visual aspect and by including human activities, the landscape has to a large extent spontaneously "transformed" into a cultural landscape'.[29] In this article, we focus on the 'maritime cultural landscape',[30] a concept created by Christer L. Westerdahl, who defined it as an entire network of shipping lanes, ports and harbours stretching along the coast, along with their associated structures and other remnants of both aquatic and terrestrial human activity.[31]

We analyse a very specific case – the Polish port city of Szczecin. Located in the far northwest corner of Poland, it is generally perceived to the rest of Poland as a coastal city even though it is situated at a considerable distance from the sea, so its natural landscape

27. Urszula Myga-Piątek, 'Spór o pojęcie krajobrazu w geografii i dziedzinach pokrewnych', *Przegląd Geograficzny*, 73, Nos 1–2 (2001), 163–76.
28. Jerzy Solon, 'Typy krajobrazu kulturowego Polski. Klasyfikacja krajobrazu. Teoria i praktyka', *Problemy Ekologii Krajobrazu*, 20 (2008), 109–15.
29. Krystyna Kamińska, 'Krajobraz kulturowy – nowa relacja człowieka ze światem (nie tylko przyrody)', *Zeszyty Naukowe Ostrołęckie Towarzystwo Naukowe im. Adama Chętnika*, 28 (2004), 241.
30. Jorge Freire, 'Maritime Cultural Landscape: A New Approach to the Cascais Coastline', *Journal of Maritime Archeology*, 9 (2013), 143–57; David J. Stewart, 'Gravestones and Monuments in the Maritime Cultural Landscape: Research Potential and Preliminary Interpretations', *The International Journal of Nautical Archaeology*, 36, No. 1 (2007), 12–124; David Tuddenham, 'Maritime Cultural Landscapes, Maritinity and Quasi Objects', *Journal of Maritime Archeology*, 5 (2010), 5–16; Yftinus T. Van Popta, Christer L. Westerdahl and Brad G. Duncan, 'Maritime Culture in the Netherlands: Accessing the Late Medieval Maritime Cultural Landscapes of the North-eastern Zuiderzee', *International Journal of Nautical Archaeology*, 48, No. 1 (2019), 172–88; Christer Westerdahl, 'The Maritime Cultural Landscape', *International Journal of Nautical Archeology*, 21 (1992), 5–14; Christer Westerdahl, 'From River to Sea Catching the Monsoon, Concepts of the Maritime Landscapes', in Latika Varadarajan (ed.), *Indo-Portuguese Encounters, Journeys in Science, Technology and Culture, vol. 1* (Lisbon and New Delhi, 2016), 334–50.
31 Westerdahl, 'The Maritime Cultural Landscape'; Christer Westerdahl, 'Fish and Ships. Towards a Theory of Maritime Culture', *Deutches Schiffahrtsarchiv*, 30 (2007), 212.

does not have any of the typical elements of a coast. The waters of the Szczecin harbour only technically come from the sea, according to the official legal status ascribed to bays, lagoons and the waters of sea ports. Despite this ambiguity, the sea is directly present in many of the city's cultural events (e.g. annual 'Sea Days'[32] or 'Tall Ship Races'), in general culture (e.g. the popularity of shanties, regional fish dishes) and even in the names of local products (e.g. Bosman beer – *Boatswain beer*).

The maritime cultural landscape can therefore be analysed from a topographical and a cultural (including aesthetic) perspective, the two of which may overlap. The topographical perspective reflects the maritime elements that are located on the coast, ranging from signs and elements directly associated with the sea to the geographical features of the study area. From a cultural perspective, the focus is on the ritual and symbolic aspects of the coast.[33] It is important to note that many aspects of maritime cultural landscapes are still unexplored, and the research that does exist is rarely comprehensive. Most often, researchers focus on analysing various features of maritime cultural landscapes and making reports on the cultural landscapes of particular regions.[34]

In summary, the primary area of our analysis is the selected maritime spatial elements of the Polish port city of Szczecin, which mainly have aesthetic, identity-building and commemorative functions, and are treated as important cultural artefacts of the urban space. These include various types of monuments, sculptural accents, reliefs, commemorative plaques and also elements associated with the port and shipyard heritage. Other elements of maritime culture in Szczecin are supplementary, enriching and emphasizing the character of the city.

'Old and new': maritime cultural objects as an important elements of the urban landscape

Generally there are two basic categories of maritime monuments: those which have a primarily commemorative function, and those which only have an aesthetic and decorative character. Monuments of the first type create a specific 'landscape of memory' and help create the identity of a place, as described in a maritime context by David J. Stewart and Norbert Fischer.[35] Stewart drew on examples of Anglo-American maritime memory to describe different types of maritime monuments, including where they were located and the limitations of monuments as archaeological artefacts. The criterion for his classification of maritime monuments was the identification of the state, community or individuals who commissioned the memorial. Norbert Fischer, on the other hand,

32. According to the research on the state and perspectives of Szczecin's cultural institutions, 'Energy of Szczecin's Culture' (2019), commissioned by the City of Szczecin, 'Sea Days' has been recognized as the city's business card and most visited cultural event.
33. Westerdahl, 'From River to Sea Catching the Monsoon', 334.
34 Stewart, 'Gravestones and Monuments', 112.
35. Stewart, 'Gravestones and Monuments'; Norbert Fischer, 'Maritime Death, Memory and Landscape: Examples from the North Sea Coast and the Islands' in Linde Egberts and Meindert Schroor (eds), *Waddenland Outstanding. History, Landscape and Cultural Heritage of the Wadden Sea Region* (Amsterdam, 2018), 169–80.

characterized the maritime landscape of memory using examples from the North Sea coast, which consists of numerous artefacts and relics with a special cultural heritage and specific cultural symbols. The symbolic marks of commemorations of death at sea, such as monuments and reliefs, flood signs and shipwrecks, which are usually placed in central locations such as ports, promenades and viewpoints, are an important part of this coastal landscape. According to Fischer, they create a narrative about the region's unique history. As the researcher notes, the initiators of the monuments are mainly representatives of local and regional associations (e.g. fishing, sailing), church communities, etc.

There is a relatively large number of publications devoted to big monuments as works of art that carry important cultural value and commemorate important events or people. However, the monuments, sculptural accents and reliefs which perform the function of aestheticizing the space and giving it a maritime atmosphere, have been treated marginally. It should be emphasized that they, too, influence the shape of the cultural landscape of the maritime city and the sense of the maritime character of the space. When creating a typology of maritime elements that are part of the urban space, it is possible to base this on a variety of criteria: time, importance, social reception, fulfilled functions, e.g. informational or aesthetic. It is worth noting, however, that the aforementioned characteristics may differ in importance. In our opinion, the most significant criterion for various maritime elements of the urban space in Szczecin is the date of creation, i.e. whether they are of German (before 1945) or Polish (after 1945) origin.

German past

Time is a key criterion in defining the maritime character of Szczecin. Its urban space combines elements of German and Polish history, with a clear boundary at the time of the annexation by Poland in 1945, when, following an agreement reached by the Allies of World War II, eastern German lands became Polish. This included the major German city of Stettin which was transformed into Polish Szczecin. The city had formally been ruled by German-speaking states since 1720 – first Prussia and then the united German Empire. Located just 140 km northeast of Berlin, Stettin was subject to two intense Allied carpet-bombing raids between 1943 and 1945, which, added to the direct hostilities between the Red Army and the city's defence, left the vast majority of the city in ruins, especially the port and industrial facilities. By 1946, virtually the entire remaining German population (from 383,000 just before the war) had been forced out of the city. However, owing to the unclear legal status of the city and the annexed lands, the citizens of Szczecin maintained a strong sense of precariousness for many decades and only recently have they started to appreciate their German history and cultural heritage without the fear of losing the city to Germany.

Taking into consideration the German monuments in Szczecin, we can divide them into different, often overlapping categories. This is not a finite division, as it is possible to apply a different criterion and produce a different typology. In the consciousness of the city inhabitants, the significance of the monuments belonging to the German heritage of Szczecin varies. Some of them are well known (or remembered), others only marginally. Another criterion is the degree of social acceptance of a given object. Some of them

strongly polarize local Polish public opinion, which is visible in the division of supporters and opponents of a given monument. Opponents often negatively perceive Germanic monuments owing to their connections to German history or attitudes, such as imperialism. There are also those to which the city's community displays a neutral attitude. Szczecin's German monuments can also be divided according to aesthetic criteria or form: boulders, obelisks, sculptures, columns and others. It is also possible to indicate the power criterion in cases where we are dealing with monuments that were erected in honour of a figure or event.

Sedina is one of the most interesting monuments in Szczecin, which combines all of the aforementioned criteria. During the German era, the monument of Sedina became the unofficial protector and patron of the city. During World War II, the monument disappeared, which has resulted in many unverified hypotheses as to what happened to it. There is one theory that says it was melted down for ammunition, a scarce commodity for German soldiers at the end of the war, while another one says that it was dismantled by Soviet troops and taken away. After the war, the local communist authorities placed an anchor on the site where the Sedina monument had been before. Now, at least for some residents of the city, it is a symbol of economic stagnation. Nowadays, Sedina is again the symbolic patron of Szczecin; however, this is not in the form of a monument to a proud female sailor, but as a legend of a beautiful monument that epitomized the maritime character of the city. One may even reach the conclusion that the current memory of the work and its social reception is even more favourable than during the German era of the city. It is currently the most extensively described monument – a phantom that does not exist, and yet, at the same time, exists in the consciousness of citizens. There are also voices of dissent from those who do not want any symbols associated with the German history and heritage of the city. This position is presented by the proponents of the so-called *deteutonizacja* (de-Germanization), who believe that all signs of German history found in the Western and Northern Territories of Poland should be removed forever. It is interesting to note that in the case of Szczecin, it is actually only the Sedina monument that has come under attack. Other manifestations of 'Germanness' or monuments erected during that period do not raise similarly heated debates or resentment.[36]

At this point, it is appropriate to mention a monument erected in the then German city of Stettin commemorating the sailors who died while serving on the cruiser *Augsburg* in 1915. Some 370 sailors who fought in World War I served on board the cruiser. On 24/25 January 1915, the ship fell into a Russian minefield. The vessel got to the port in Szczecin, and was then renovated at the *Blohm u. Voss* shipyard in Hamburg. The memory of the sailors' service was honoured in the form of a monument – a boulder located in the Central Cemetery in Szczecin. Initially, it was placed at the garrison cemetery, which was incorporated into the Central Cemetery after 1945. On the front side of the boulder there is a large inscription: 'They died a heroic death for Kaiser and Fatherland 25.1.1915 on board *SMS Augsburg*' followed by the ranks, names and dates of birth of individual seamen.[37]

36. Tadeusz Białecki, 'Jak to z Sediną bywało: w sukurs niemieckim nacjonalistom', *Kurier Szczeciński*, 164 (2007), 15.
37. Pomniki i tablice Szczecina at: www.szczecin.pl/chapter_59232.asp?soid=AC8C65B8C7D149E482333DEE259DE28B (accessed 4 July 2020).

Another German monument, which is known to locals only through hearsay and historical records, is a sculpture depicting Poseidon's wife, Amphitrite, a Greek goddess and the queen of the sea. This work of art was erected in 1902 on the east side of the Berlin Gate (today Port Gate). The naked goddess stood in a shell that served as her chariot. In 1932, the statue was removed for at least two reasons. Firstly, the street where the monument stood required reconstruction owing to problems of local transportation. The second reason was related to morality. Some of the city's residents felt that the monument was too bold in its artistic expression and that it 'caused public scandal'. As a result of protests, it was removed and dismantled.[38]

German monuments in Szczecin are part of the city's identity, including its maritime identity. Some of them unite and divide contemporary users of the urban space; some are still remembered, others have been forgotten. There are some that evoke a positive or ambivalent attitude, and some that spur residents to action. It seems, however, that the monument of Sedina is the one whose memory is still alive and well preserved. Proponents of her return to her former place have even formed an association that is working to ensure that the proud seawoman of Szczecin will once again stand in her former place. Regardless of the attitudes of the city's residents towards its German heritage, the monument has become a permanent part of the city's history, creating its identity, including maritime identity.

Communist period

The post-war history of the city is also associated with the cultivation and care of its maritime character. The communist authorities of the time made every effort to carry out the tasks of maritime policy according to the slogan: 'The whole nation in the service of the sea'. The most important elements of this policy included the raising of awareness of the sea, maritime education, the development of inland shipping and maritime trade, support of the development of maritime industry and – what is of particular interest to the authors – the undertaking of various activities in the field of maritime art,[39] including the erection of plaques, bas-reliefs, sculptural accents and maritime monuments. Accordingly, a variety of elements referring to the maritime character of the city started to appear in the city space.

Another popular form of maritime education or propaganda comprised the various competitions for memoirs and diaries. The then Szczecin Voivodship Office in 1949 announced a 'Competition for a Seafarer's Diary'. Although the title suggests that it only referred to one category of seafarers, detailed documentation of the competition also indicates that it was addressed to various professional groups associated with the

38. Szczepan Borusewicz, 'Szczecińskie pomniki', *Kronika Szczecina*, 21 (2002), 72; Marian Wrzosek, 'Pożegnanie z Amfitrytą', *Sedina.pl Magazyn*, 4 (2009), 52–4; 'Sedina, Amfitryta i … dziewczyna z magnoliami'. Available at: www.szczecin.wyborcza.pl/szczecin/1,34939,6895078 (accessed 4 July 2020).

39. National Archives in Szczecin (hereinafter APS), Municipal Administration and City Council (hereinafter ZMiMRNS), Sea League, Branch in Szczecin 1945–1950 (hereinafter LM ZOS), file reference number 205, 1–23, *Statute of the Sea League and Sea Defence Fund*.

maritime economy.[40] It was no coincidence that this appeal was addressed specifically to people associated with the sea. The central authorities believed that the industry and the maritime economy would become an important part of the national economy.

In an attempt to create a typology of monuments created in Szczecin during the People's Republic of Poland (1945–1989), we can use political, economic and aesthetic criteria. It should be mentioned that it is impossible to draw a clear line of demarcation between the past and the present. The past has an impact on the present, on the formation of social identity, and it is worth remembering this. It should also be added that the political criterion, or the criterion of power, is a very important element in creating, in this case, a typology of maritime monuments of Szczecin. As Aleksander Wallis, sociologist of the city, said: 'He who has power erects monuments'.[41]

Taking into account the political criterion, it should be emphasized that maritime objects more or less glorified the maritime economy and maritime industry, whose development in the years 1945–1989 was very important. Thus, various maritime objects began to appear in the city space, more or less related to the widely understood maritime economy. Monuments were erected to commemorate seamen, fishermen and sailors, all categories directly related to the sea. Homage was also paid to those who were indirectly associated with it, such as shipyard workers, dockers and port workers.

One such monument, dedicated to seafarers with the inscription 'To those who did not return from the sea', is located at the Central Cemetery. Created in 1989, it was dedicated to those who 'were taken by the sea and never given back'. The idea of a monument commemorating the perished seafarers was born among seamen living in Szczecin and accomplished thanks to the support of Szczecin's Master Mariners' Club. The idea came from the sense of duty of those who had returned from the sea to those who had not. In addition, it was intended to address the needs of seafarers' families, deprived of graves of their loved ones. The monument was conceived as a common grave for those who perished at sea. Maritime symbolism dictates the form of the monument – it resembles the deck of a ship that is flooded by waves, from among which a mast emerges – a cross overgrown with shells and algae. Behind the monument are brass plaques commemorating ships and vessels that were sunk during the war, and the names of sailors who perished at sea. The list of those who did not return from the sea is not finished – plaques with the names, surnames and ranks of the victims of maritime disasters are still added. This monument is not only an expression of the maritime character of Szczecin, it is also a tribute paid by city residents to those who did not reach their home shores.[42] Seafarers are also remembered by a commemorative plaque funded by a

40. APS, Szczeciński Voivodship Office, file reference number 5044, 4–9, *Competition for a Mariner's Diary [1949]*.
41. Aleksander Wallis, 'Pamięć i pomnik', in Jolanta Kulpińska (ed.), *Społeczeństwo i socjologia* (Wrocław, 1985), 32–47.
42. Wiktor B. Czapp, 'Tym, którzy nie powrócili z morza', *Stella Maris*, 1 (2000), 7–8; Krystyna Pohl, 'Pomnik ma 15 lat', *Głos Szczeciński*, 245 (2004), 9; M. Słomiński, *Cmentarz Centralny w Szczecinie* (Szczecin, 2005); Monika Stefanek, 'Tym, co odeszli na wieczną wachtę', *Głos Szczeciński*, 157 (2003), 5; Bogdan Twardochleb, 'Mahler ze światłami: "Tym, którzy nie powrócili z morza …"', *Kurier Szczeciński*, 113 (2011), 11.

number of companies associated with the maritime industry.[43] The ceremonial unveiling of the memorial plaque took place in 1992 during the celebration of Sea Days. It is located in the Chapel of Seafarers, in St James' Cathedral.[44]

Another important element of the postwar urban space of Szczecin is the statue of a sailor/helmsman in the city centre, erected in 1980. The monument was the idea of the Society of Friends of Szczecin, which, from 1972, promoted the initiative of introducing monuments and sculptures with maritime motifs. The figure of the sailor/helmsman is dressed in clothes which, in popular thought, are associated with a sailor's uniform: a sailor's blouse, long pants extending downwards and a cap without a peak. The monument towers over the surrounding area with a height of nearly 5 m. In his hands he holds a steering wheel as if determining the direction of the city's development.[45]

There is also a monument to 'Captain K. Maciejewicz' in the city – a mast of the ship named after the famous sea captain and educator which used to stand in the middle of a major highway entering the city centre. The great sea captain Konstanty Matyjewicz-Maciejewicz (1890–1972) was born in Russia and this was where he became a man of the sea. In Szczecin, he became famous as the 'captain of captains', educating many sailors and organizing maritime education in the city.[46] In 2000 he took sixth place in a poll of outstanding representatives of Szczecin. In 1973, a steamer built in 1929 by the Vulcan shipyard in Bremen ended its operational service and stood as a school ship at the Maritime High School at Wały Chrobrego. From then on, it slowly blended into the city landscape. In 1982, the ship was scrapped and only a 30 m mast remained, which, during the celebration of Sea Days in Szczecin in 1991, was named after the great sea captain Konstanty Maciejewicz.[47]

The reception of the monument-mast among the city inhabitants is mixed. Some see it as an example of 'shipyard art' while others have called it 'a bunch of sticks'.[48] However, although the aesthetics of the monument itself may evoke mixed feelings, the idea of its creation does not give rise to extreme attitudes. The monument not only emphasizes the maritime character of Szczecin, but also refers to maritime professionals living in the city. First of all, it refers to seamen, the most typical representatives of the 'people of the sea'. In writer Marek Koszur's definition, 'a sailor is a man like us, if not better. […] He is

43. The founders include the Polish Steamship Company, the Polish Baltic Shipping Company, the Deep Sea Fishing and Fishery Service Company 'Gryf', the Deep Sea Fishing and Fishery Service Company 'Odra', the Sea Fishing Company 'Transocean' and the National Seamen and Fishermen's Section of the Solidarity Trade Union.
44. Tadeusz Białecki, 'Kościół św. Jakuba' in Tadeusz Białecki (ed.), *Encyklopedia Szczecina, t. 1* (Szczecin, 1999), 487–9.
45. Urszula Kozłowska, 'Pomniki Szczecina – elementy społecznej pamięci' in Agnieszka Kołodziej – Durnaś (ed.), *Region Zachodniopomorski – kolaż socjologiczny* (Warsaw, 2007), 15–6.
46. Marek Koszur, *Kapitan kapitanów* (Szczecin, 1987).
47. Bogdan Czubasiewicz, 'Kapitan kapitanów: Konstanty Maciejewicz', *Kurier Szczeciński*, 191 (2003), 15; Joanna Kozakowska (ed.), *Tablice pamiątkowe, pomniki, akcenty rzeźbiarskie Szczecina* (Szczecin, 2012); Krystyna Pohl, 'Kapitan Kapitanów', *Głos Szczeciński*, 3 (2008), 15; Marek Rudnicki, 'Kapitan kapitanów Konstanty "Macaj" nadal czeka na zaokrętowanie', *Głos Szczeciński, dod. Głos Szczecina*, 63 (2019), 6.
48. Janusz Ławrynowicz, 'Maszt Maciejewicza', *Kurier Szczeciński*, 112 (2005), 16.

better through his ability to make the world smaller, the world that he sees over and over again. He is better through the everyday hardship of living and working in conditions so different from those on land. He is better because he is filled with the most beautiful of human feelings, of which longing is the most important'.[49] In 2013, the monument mast was dismantled and underwent a major renovation. In 2018, it was again installed in an urban space. This time, the ceremonial hoisting of the flag on the mast took place on modernized Łasztownia, an industrial river island dubbed 'the new heart of the city'.

The various sculptures and reliefs that emphasize the maritime character of the city are also meaningful, although less spectacular. It is worth mentioning here that in the 1980s, the city authorities commissioned a project to place 12 sculptures in the urban space, including some with maritime motifs, mainly concerning marine fauna and flora. These are 'Shells' (Lotników Square), 'Sea Birds' tied with an invisible net (Lotników Square), the 'Albatros' (Pope John Paul II Avenue) and 'Old and New', which symbolizes two mutually intertwining sailing ships (Pope John Paul II Avenue). These elements only have an aesthetic value and are not associated with any political message or historical context.

A slightly different style was used for a series by the Szczecin Maritime Chronicle, currently located on Piastowski Boulevard (formerly known as the Boulevard of Pomeranian Piasts).[50] This consists of 42 compositions in the form of plaques and sculptural accents. It was created on the initiative of the then Municipal National Council in Szczecin, in order to commemorate the work of shipyard workers, sailors, fishermen and port workers. Its formal unveiling took place during the celebration of Sea Days on 22 June 1968. The reliefs forming the Maritime Chronicle of Szczecin include one dedicated to Henryk Jendza (1921–1962), an engineer associated with the development of the shipbuilding industry in the city. As the first director of the Odra Shipyard (later the Szczecin Shipyard), he supervised the reconstruction of shipyard facilities which had been destroyed or heavily damaged during the war. One of the ships built by the Szczecin Shipyard, a cargo ship sailing under the Polish flag, is also named after him.[51]

The monuments of the city's communist period reflect the spirit of the times, when the economy and maritime industry played an important role in the city's identity. Although those times also saw the erection of monuments not related to the sea, they were assigned a mainly decorative or ornamental role. Both are part of the city's maritime landscape, performing fundamentally different functions. One can get the impression that it was during this period that the category of monuments officially required by the authorities of the time was dominant in the maritime cultural landscape of the city. Another important phenomenon that manifested itself in the urban space was the contestation of German heritage.

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49. Marek Koszur, *Kapitan kapitanów* (Szczecin, 1987), 6.
50. Piastowski Boulevard (German Bollwerk), historical name – 'Quay'. The coastal street was located along the Oder riverbank. After 1945, it was called Vasco da Gama Street. Later, it was referred to as the Boulevard of the Pomeranian Piasts and Piastowski Boulevard, as well as the Wieleckie Quay and Nadodrzański Boulevard. As part of 'The Promenade with the Oder view' project – 'Reconstruction of Szczecin boulevards', the Piastowski Boulevard was thoroughly rebuilt for the Tall Ships Races of 2013.
51. Urszula Kozłowska, *Stoczniowcy Szczecina w procesie zmian społecznych: studium socjologiczne Stoczni Szczecińskiej SA* (Szczecin, 2008).

Present day

The city of Szczecin remembers all of the people of the sea, including seamen, in the modernized and restored Piastowski Boulevard and Avenue of Sailors, where there are a number of maritime sculptures and bas-reliefs. The works restoring the splendour of this area began in January 2011 and were completed in July 2013. It is another place where the German past of the city merges with the present, where the contemporary identity of the city merges with its history.

The Avenue of Sailors starts with a sculpture of Wyszak's boat, Wyszak being a legendary medieval sailor, merchant and buccaneer, who made his fortune in sea trade and numerous looting expeditions. Legend has it that while Wyszak was awaiting his death sentence in a Danish prison, he had a vision of Otto of Bamberg, the Christianiser of Pomerania. Wyszak made a pact with him that, in return for saving him from death, he would convert to Christianity. He saved himself from the death penalty by escaping across the sea on a tiny boat.[52] The memory of Wyszak is still present in the city space. His figure, as an element of the fountain, is also present on the Chrobry Embankment. Wyszak, as befits a buccaneer, holds a small sword in his right hand lowered along his body, while his left holds a small steering wheel. Similarly to Sedina, the image of Wyszak is also used by the contemporary inhabitants of Szczecin, for example by the Wyszak Brewery, a club in the fifteenth-century gothic cellar of the Old Town Hall.

The Avenue of Sailors also includes other monuments that commemorate both sea people and great sea expeditions. One of them is the famous yacht captain Ludomir Mączka (1926–2006), whose monument was unveiled in 2015. Born in Lviv, Szczecin's most famous sailor was also a traveller and a geologist who had journeyed more than 170,000 nautical miles. He sailed across the Pacific, the Indian Ocean and the Atlantic several times. Before the monument in the Avenue of Sailors, the memory of Captain Mączka was commemorated by his friends from the AZS Yacht Club. On a red granite boulder located in front of the Yacht Club, an inscription was placed: 'In memory of Ludomir Mączka, the sailor/geologist who set off from here into the world, May 2007'.[53]

In 2018, the Avenue of Sailors saw the unveiling of a statue commemorating an unusual character – Umbriaga, the cat who loved to sail. The red cat Umbriaga was a real animal living in the late 1940s at the marina of the Academic Maritime Association in Szczecin. Owing to the fact that he loved sailing, students from

52. Tadeusz Białecki, 'Wyszak – patron żeglarzy', *Kurier Szczeciński*, 106 (2008), 12; Tadeusz Białecki, 'Postawmy mu pomnik: Wyszak, to dobry symbol dla Szczecina', *Kurier Szczeciński*, 211 (2009), 13; Władysław Filipowiak, 'My z Wyszaka: morskie tradycje Szczecina', *Kurier Szczeciński*, 115 (2008), 11; Krystyna Pohl, 'Wyszak – patron żeglarzy?', *Obserwator Morski*, 3 (2013), 35.

53. Tadeusz Białecki, 'Mączka Ludomir', in Białecki Tadeusz (ed.), *Encyklopedia Szczecina. Suplement 1* (Uniwersytet Szczeciński: Szczecin), 156; Tadeusz Białecki, 'Mączka Ludomir', in Tadeusz Białecki (ed.), *Encyklopedia Szczecina. Suplement 2* (Uniwersytet Szczeciński: Szczecin), 181; Marek Rudnicki, 'Ludomir Mączka żeglarz świata', *Głos Szczeciński, dod. Głos ma historia*, 149 (2014), 23; Marek Rudnicki, 'Ludomir Mączka już stoi. Nieoficjalnie', *Głos Szczeciński*, 104 (2015), 5.

Szczecin willingly took him on cruises on the yachts *Biały Słoń* and *Tuna*. Unfortunately, during one of the cruises, he went ashore in the northern part of Dębina island and disappeared.[54] The image of the cat in the Avenue of Sailors has anthropomorphic features: he stands on his two hind legs, wears trousers and rests his front paws on his hips. Next to him is a coil of sailing rope on which a seagull is sitting. The statue is particularly popular with children and the figure is used in the sailing education of young children. He is a protagonist of shanties and a book, and the patron of a sailing award for children. The Avenue of Sailors also contains other maritime accents in the Alley: a sextant, an astrolabe and various plaques commemorating the development of sailing in Western Pomerania.

In Szczecin, the maritime cultural landscape includes the landscape of the harbour, whose specificity is determined by harbour facilities in the form of buildings, railroad tracks, halls, cranes, overhead cranes and slipways. This landscape significantly determines the identity of the place, but, on the other hand, is gradually degrading owing to the collapse of the shipbuilding industry. In 1989, a radical transformation of the socio-political system began in Poland. It was felt particularly hard by the industrial workers who had played a leading role in the previous system. The socialist system, however, turned out to be ineffective when faced with the free market. After 1989, shipyard workers faced very similar problems to the majority of employees in various industrial plants throughout Poland. The bankruptcy of Szczecin Shipyard SA was announced in 2002.

Zbigniew Paszkowski observed that 'this specifically industrial aquatic urban landscape, enhanced by the reflections of tall cranes in the water, is gradually being obliterated by the atrophy of the shipbuilding industry and the declining role of traditional sea and river ports in Central Europe'.[55] However, the cultural landscape of ports and shipyards is undoubtedly an element of the region's cultural heritage as a place of work and manufacturing, i.e. those elements of social life that for many years influenced the development of the city and provided a living for many of its inhabitants. This creates an important dilemma of whether we should preserve at least some of the port structures and buildings that may otherwise easily disappear from the urban landscape. Some propose a 'museum-type' solution, with the defunct cranes cared for and serviced so that they can still operate; others argue that the cranes should be preserved to contribute to the cultural landscape by locking and securing them in a 'mummified' state.[56]

With regard to activities related to port and shipbuilding areas that have lost their original function, we speak about space recycling. By recycling inactive areas of the city, these spaces gain new functions and forms of use. It is important not to ignore the local character of the space.[57] This requires a special reference to the cultural heritage

54. Available at: www.szczecin.wyborcza.pl/szczecin/7,34939,23482949,pomnik-kota-który-lubil-zeglowac-stoi-już-na-bulwarze-odslonil.html (accessed 13 August 2020).
55. Zbigniew Władysław Paszkowski, 'Czy ochrona krajobrazu portowego w Szczecinie ma sens?/Is there any sense of port landscape protection in Szczecin?', *Przestrzeń i Forma'*, 15 (2015), 369.
56. Ibid., 367–74.
57. Jane Jacobs, *The Death and Life of Great American Cities* (New York, 1961).

of the place – including its material heritage, which is often difficult to maintain and display. An example of successful space recycling is Erie Basin Park in Brooklyn, where the characteristic remains of the shipbuilding past are highlighted in space: a technical pier, dock gate and mooring infrastructure. The development of the 2 kilometre shore created a characteristic linear park, spatially defined by four port cranes that dominate the landscape. The nature of the park has been reinforced with a narrative layer related to the spatial context: iconographic materials, memories of shipyard workers, etc. All of this is a clear reference to the times when the shipyard was still prospering.[58]

In Szczecin, a similar example of mummification of shipyard artefacts is the *cranosaurs* – an installation that illuminated the old port cranes located on Szczecin's Łasztownia Island, and which gave rise to an idea that they should be protected as part of the city's heritage. They are becoming a new symbol of the city, present in songs, illustrations and photographs. Installed on the island of Łasztownia in the 1930s, probably by the German company Krupp, they were used for reloading cargo and are similar to other cranes used in ports all over Europe. Today, only a few cranes have been preserved in museums. Interestingly, the cranes were still used by Szczecin and Świnoujście Seaports Authority as late as the beginning of the twenty-first century. After they were handed over to the National Museum in Szczecin, their several months-long renovation began in 2016. Eventually, they gained their original appearance: brown bases, green cabins and yellow booms.[59] The cranes are peculiar installations consisting of recycled objects in an urban space. They are somewhere between a museum object, a monument and a visual aesthetic element of the cultural landscape. They commemorate the golden times of the port and have gained a new form and function. Every night they make the city landscape more attractive thanks to the way in which they are illuminated and, occasionally, enriched with sound. Their name suggests an imaginary, somehow fairytale existence while, at the same time, referring to the past. Half-cranes–half-dinosaurs enliven the space and respond to the search for identity by the city's inhabitants. They are a symbol of the continuity of the shipbuilding heritage of the city – German and Polish. They are also an example of combining the old with the new by giving old items a new sense and meaning. In the past, they had a function serving the port employees. Today, they commemorate the past while fulfilling an aesthetic function.

Regardless of the time of their creation, the monuments and other objects of maritime character that create the maritime cultural landscape are an important part of Szczecin's history and create its identity. On the one hand, they commemorate important events for a given community, while on the other, they have a bonding character. They unite the communities responsible for their creation. They constitute a materialized symbol of a city which should be read in a concrete space, because if moved to another place they lose their identity- and bond-building character.

58. Wiesława Gadomska, 'Modern Park as a Result of Urban Space Recycling – a Review of New York City's Developments', *Technical Transactions*, 10 (2018), 5–22.

59. Elżbieta Bielecka, *Szczecińskie 'dźwigozaury' podświetlone na stałe* (2018). Available at: https://dzieje.pl/rozmaitosci/szczecinskie-dzwigozaury-podswietlone-na-stale (accessed 16 July 2020).

Conclusion

Cultural landscapes were included as an additional category on the World Heritage List by the World Heritage Commission in the 1990s. According to the UNESCO World Heritage Centre (2005), cultural landscapes consist of three main types of landscape: landscape deliberately planned and shaped by man in relation to park areas, landscape created as a result of sociological, economic, administrative transformations and events, etc. and shaped in relation to natural conditions (relict and continued forms), and landscape as an expression of the relationship of art, culture and religion with natural elements, in which material value is less significant or absent.[60]

Szczecin, owing to the fact that it is not located directly on the sea, is a port city whose maritime character is largely created by culture. The maritime cultural landscape of Szczecin can be divided into several categories, among which the cultural heritage of the German past of the city seems to be one of the most important. Equally important is the widely understood maritime economy, including various professional categories of seamen. It is these two categories that, to a large extent, dominate the maritime landscape of the city. The monuments, sculptural elements, reliefs, plaques and installations analysed in this article were created primarily as an expression of the relationship between culture and art and the natural elements that symbolize the maritime character of the city and shape its maritime identity. Among them, heritage related to the shipyard and port is especially important. As a result of systemic transformations, they have been gradually losing their economic function in favour of historical and identity-related functions. Therefore, it seems that the analysis of the shipbuilding and port heritage is an important area for further exploration.

Taking into account Alice Mah's concept of the heritage of port cities,[61] in the case of the maritime space of Szczecin, three important dimensions can be identified: German heritage, the heritage of socialism and the heritage of labor, which is particularly visible in relation to the port and shipyard areas. It can be noticed that in the German period (before 1945) the monuments related to the maritime character of the city were primarily to emphasize the importance and size of the city. At the same time, they served aesthetic functions, constituted a kind of landmark and were the pride of the inhabitants. After the war, maritime monuments gained ideological significance and reflected the city's process of searching for a new identity – a port city associated with the sea. In contrast, after the political transformation of 1989, the focus was on shaping the recreational public space, especially that situated by the river, emphasizing the maritime identity of Szczecin, and on recycling the shipyard and port space, which was degraded as a result of macro-social changes. The analysis of the maritime cultural landscape shows that the space of Szczecin is not uniform, but is dynamic – it focuses, as if in a lens, the changes of over the last 100 years. What is important, however, is that this space retains its maritime identity.

60. Agnieszka Jaszczak and Mariusz Antolak, 'Tożsamość krajobrazu a przestrzeń społeczna', *Prace Komisji Krajobrazu Kulturowego*, 28 (2015), 109–17.
61. Alice Mah, *Port Cities and Global Legacies: Urban Identity, Waterfront Work, and Radicalism* (Basingstoke, 2014).

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